MONTHLY UPDATE

Uganda: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

The internal affairs minister launched the integration of the national identification and tax identification systems, and the revenue authority set out a two-stage move to the national identification number as the tax identifier. The ICT minister announced the procurement of an AI system for the communications regulator to filter harmful online content. Whistleblowers asked for a halt to and investigation of the procurement of motor vehicle registration components. An operator launched a satellite-to-mobile service on 24 September, and mobile-money toll payment began at three plazas on the Kampala-Entebbe Expressway.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The revenue authority began implementing a compliance risk management strategy for 2026/27 that uses taxpayer information, business transactions and sector trends to find compliance gaps. The science, technology and innovation minister said a national artificial intelligence strategy is under development, reported on 10 September.

Legislation and regulation

January's shutdown directive reached the record in its own words. A newspaper republished the Uganda Communications Commission text in full on 7 September: made on the Inter-Agency Security Committee's recommendation, it suspended public internet access, the sale and registration of new SIM cards and outbound data roaming to One Network Area countries across mobile, fibre, leased line, fixed wireless, microwave and satellite; ordered operators to disable mobile VPN services and block any public bypass; whitelisted an exclusion list covering national referral hospital systems, core banking and clearing, tax and government payment gateways, immigration, electoral commission portals, voter verification and result tabulation, utilities, air traffic control and railway signalling; required incident reporting within 30 minutes; and required any operator unable to comply to shut down its entire internet infrastructure, on pain of fines or licence suspension. The directive the repository held was a scanned PDF with no text layer.

Digital lending came before Parliament's accountability committee. The central bank governor said on 14 September that the bank will investigate claims that the mobile money operators it supervises helped digital lenders take repayments from the wallets of people who never guaranteed the loans; both large operators denied deducting money without consent and asked the communications regulator to block unlicensed lending apps.

Data protection

Three men were held at a Kampala station over alleged false news and unlawful obtaining or disclosure of personal data, reported on 1 September, on offences under the computer misuse statute; the posts, the data and the complainant are not disclosed. A TikTok user was charged with unlawfully obtaining and disclosing personal data over a photograph and video of a State House employee. The communications regulator launched a child online protection campaign at a Kampala secondary school.

Regional collaboration

Uganda and South Sudan signed a memorandum in Juba on 7 September for real-time epidemiological data sharing, mutual outbreak notification, joint surveillance and harmonised screening at border crossings. No data platform, legal safeguard or budget is named.

The revenue authority signed a third customs memorandum with South Sudan's, the first to cover digital interoperability and enforcement of Uganda's electronic permit system.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The revenue authority told manufacturers on 11 September 2026 that its e-Tax2 platform has been in build since February 2026, web-only and keyed on national identification and business registration numbers. The award remains set aside by the Appeals Tribunal; the two accounts are not reconciled.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

A second international route is being procured under a presidential directive rather than by tender. The state transmission company cancelled open bidding for a commercialisation partner for its fibre network and moved to prepare a proposal for a single named company for the Uganda-Tanzania connection, the parliamentary committee on state enterprises asking why firms that had expressed interest were dropped. A State House letter of 27 August 2025 had told the ICT and energy ministers that a Tanzanian route could be cheaper than the existing route through Kenya, which the President described as full of commercial players looking for profit. No contract, value, timetable or committee finding is held, and the cost comparison is an assertion.

The second operator followed with a service rather than a partnership: it launched Starlink satellite-to-mobile SMS and light data for compatible smartphones on 24 September, free for 30 days and then through its data bundles, with no coverage or subscriber figure.

The President directed cancellation of the agreement to revive the state telecoms operator, the investor having failed to inject an initial US$25m while seeking control of the national backbone; a Cabinet paper on a state-funded revival is to follow.

Data Storage

A former head of the communications regulator wrote that the information technology authority's strategic plan provides for a third national data centre, with a primary site at Entebbe and disaster recovery at Jinja, guided by a market study launched in 2025. The centre had been removed from the World Bank project in 2025, and no financing or timetable is stated.

Cybersecurity

The bankers' association counted 6,533 cyber and fraud incidents in the financial sector between January and August 2026, with UGX 24bn lost and a further UGX 68bn estimated at risk, naming wallet and peer-to-peer fraud and digital-channel compromise among the persistent threats. The Deputy Chief Justice said the judiciary is open to specialised handling of cyber and financial crime cases.

DPI

Data Exchange

The month's exchange story is a border system working for someone else. The revenue authority, with its Kenyan counterpart, continues to enforce a US-dollar e-Permit charge on imports bound for South Sudan, levied before any tax assessment is issued, on behalf of a UK-registered firm the United States sanctioned in May over the diversion of public resources and foreign assistance; the firm's staff are deployed at border points under South Sudan Revenue Authority cover, and the Tanzanian and Rwandan authorities have publicly dissociated themselves from the arrangement. The revenue authority is not recorded as answering the account, and no agreement or legal basis for the Ugandan side is published. The information technology authority said on 1 October that its integration platform connects the identity register to more than 150 agencies, banks and telecoms operators for real-time verification.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The Cabinet decision of 1 September was narrowed twice in the week after it. The finance minister said on 3 September that it does not make the identification number the taxpayer number but requires the two to be interoperable — "we are not saying the NIN is the TIN; we are saying the NIN and the TIN must be able to read each other", and the revenue authority added on 7 September that holding an identification number does not by itself make its holder a taxpayer, the purpose being a single secure identifier for government services and more accurate taxpayer records. The decision itself is not held, and no instrument, commencement date or migration plan has been published for what is now described as two identifiers reading each other rather than one replacing the other.

The cards are printed and not working. The registration authority holds about 5.4 million printed cards uncollected, with 418 of 571 posts filled and 201 at client counters, and told legislators on 9 September that one mobile operator is the only partner fully onboarded to the information-exchange module it opened in March, so new cards are refused at banks and SIM counters.

The revenue authority then gave a firmer account than the finance minister's: the TIN will be phased out for individuals in favour of the NIN, with companies using their registration number.

The internal affairs minister launched the integration of the national identification and tax identification systems at the first national identity expo in Kololo, reported on 30 September. No commencement date or count of linked records is given. The registration authority announced a nationwide exercise in December 2026 to register learners without identification numbers and correct errors in identity records.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 22 September Afreximbank issued a US$29m guarantee to the operator of the regional customs bond platform, which was piloted in Uganda from August 2025 and launched across the Community in March 2026. No uptake figure is published.

A microfinance bank moved onto a switch operator's network on 22 September, putting deposits, withdrawals, loan repayments and bill payments with more than 21,000 agents and its debit cards on more than 650 ATMs. No cost or customer target is stated.

The expressway then moved partly off cash. On 25 September MTN Mobile Money toll payment launched with the works ministry at the Busega, Kajjansi and Mpala plazas on two designated lanes, the motorist approving a PIN prompt on the phone. No other wallet and no fee is named.

Registries

A sectoral register was added beside them. The trade, industry and cooperatives ministry, with the National Sugar Stakeholders Council, launched a Sugar Industry Information Management System to register every sugarcane farmer in the country and centralise data across cane cultivation, harvesting, milling, processing, distribution and market trends. No farmer count, registration deadline, cost or data-protection provision is published, and nothing states how it relates to the national identification register.

The country's other identifier-bearing register went the other way. Parliament's infrastructure committee opened a fact-finding inquiry into the digital number plate system on 2 September after complaints from vehicle dealers: daily production has fallen from about 350 plates to about 100, and members put the cost of the backlog at more than 4bn shillings a week against a first-registration fee of 714,300 shillings. The weekly loss is legislators' own estimate rather than an audited figure, and the operator has published no account of the shortfall.

The same contractor is the subject of a further purchase. Whistleblowers asked the President, the Inspectorate of Government, the Auditor General and the procurement regulator to halt a proposed Shs158bn works ministry procurement of vehicle registration components from the digital number plate contractor, arguing that it pays twice for functions in the original contract and ties the vehicle registry to one foreign vendor. The paper states that the claims were not independently established, and no ministry response is held. On 30 September the works and transport ministry told Parliament's infrastructure committee the number plate backlog is cleared, component supplies having been restored in August, with fitment at Kampala bonds down from 19 days in December 2025 to two; the committee keeps the project under oversight. The Attorney General told a parliamentary committee that the supplier has failed the core obligations of the 2021 number-plate contract, which a newspaper reports him declaring null and illegal.

The Judiciary is digitising the Chief Registrar's records on advocates and bailiffs: all files have been scanned, data capture into a searchable system comes next, and the first phase is due by the end of October 2026.

Sectoral management information systems

A private platform entered the health stack from outside it. A digital-health company launched a platform on 3 September letting urban specialists run virtual multidisciplinary ward rounds with rural inpatient teams in real time, with per-bed cryptographic tokens and triage on live vital signs, covering more than 260 medical wards it says often lack cardiologists, neurologists and intensivists. No facility list, patient volume, tariff, clinical evaluation or integration with the national health information stack is published.

The parish programme's system was audited short of its design. The Auditor-General found two of seven pillar modules fully implemented, 178 of 13,253 parish tablets non-functional, 29 with ineligible users and none supported with internet connectivity, and in September one district reported 31 of its 61 tablets dead and parishes back on manual records.

The tax stamps system published its scale: more than 1,680 manufacturers and importers registered across 13 excisable products, run for the revenue authority by SICPA since 2018.

The parish model's reach was restated. An inter-ministerial meeting put it at 3,571,108 beneficiaries against UGX 4.317 trillion capitalised through 10,589 parish SACCOs, lending up to UGX 1 million at 6 per cent a year. The count is the government's own.

The facility record system drew its first district-level complaint on this record. Health workers in Kiryandongo told a public meeting on 19 September that the ministry's electronic medical record system, introduced in selected facilities in 2016, stalls care for want of connectivity, stable power and computers. No national count of facilities running it is published.

The Judiciary is running a data-cleaning exercise in nine Cluster 10 courts from 6 to 16 October 2026, reconciling physical files against the Court Case Administration System before the courts move to the electronic case management system.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The procurement system was restated as a fiscal-discipline instrument rather than a procurement one, the finance minister setting it alongside budget-execution controls and the accounting profession's own role in evidence-based decision-making at a professional seminar on 3 September. No new onboarding or throughput figures came with it.

The revenue authority told manufacturers its replacement tax platform has been in build since February 2026, web-only and keyed on national identity and business registration numbers, an account that sits unreconciled with the award the Appeals Tribunal set aside. The government printer made the electronic Uganda Gazette free to the public, with the gazette digitised back to 1902.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Local-government finance got a system of its own on 22 September, when the local government ministry launched its computerised accounting and reporting tool in Hoima city, stating that it had reached 25 lower local governments and 41 health units and schools. No national target is given.

Technology

AI

A domestic model reached a continental prize rather than a deployment: a startup building credit scoring for smallholder farmers who lack collateral took US$50,000, about 190m shillings, in growth funding at a Kigali food-systems summit. No user count, lender partnership, loan volume or model documentation is published. In the same week the state set artificial intelligence against a sector rather than a system, making "Digital Agenda and Artificial Intelligence to Redesign Tourism" the theme of national World Tourism Day celebrations, against 793,815 visitors in the first half of 2026 and receipts up 25.6% to 2.30tn shillings — a framing with no programme, budget or system behind it.

Mbarara University of Science and Technology leads the data-pipeline and machine-learning work in a four-year, GBP 4.4m Wellcome Trust microscopy programme led by the University of Cape Town, which began in September 2026. The civil aviation authority has moved Entebbe airport's car parks onto AI-assisted number-plate recognition and mobile-money payment, reported 9 October 2026, and says it keeps vehicle registration records, timestamps and payment logs indefinitely, releasing them to security agencies under statutory guidelines.

ICT Industry

One domestic firm passed into foreign ownership, and the consideration is not on the record. A Nigerian technology company acquired a Ugandan banking-software firm, bringing every stage of credit — from verifying the borrower's identity to repayment — onto a single platform, the companies saying the combination lets African financial institutions assess loan applications faster and lend more readily. No price is disclosed, and no revenue, customer count, headcount or regulatory clearance is published for either party — so what left the country cannot be sized.

Innovation ecosystem

Belgium's development agency opened a tender on 21 September for a women-in-tech community platform and the sourcing of 12 African and European ventures, under a 2026-2028 programme covering Uganda, Tanzania and Senegal. No contract value is stated. The communications regulator re-advertised its call for a single partner to run the third phase of its innovation programme, closing on 12 October.

Capacity

Literacy

The month's only literacy movement is an operator's, not the state's: a mobile classroom run by the largest mobile operator's foundation graduated 305 people in Kampala on 18 September, taking the number trained to more than 6,700 in safe internet use, digital productivity and responsible use of digital financial services. No cost, geographic spread or outcome measure beyond the graduate count is published, so what is held is a throughput figure rather than a measure of literacy.

Training and skills

The same operator handed over the second of four university innovation hubs under a Shs4 billion three-year programme at Busitema.

Research institutions

Academic research capacity enters this record for the first time, and as a conversation. The national university and Japan's international cooperation agency explored strengthening academic, research and innovation collaboration between Uganda, Japan and other African countries, with a focus on artificial intelligence, aerospace engineering, materials and remote sensing, food value chains, energy, water and climate change. No agreement, funding, programme or timetable is named on either side.

Inclusion

Access to services

Mobile-industry research put internet use at about a quarter of refugee women against about half of refugee men, with device and data costs the main barrier.

The ICT ministry described a Smart Villages pilot classroom in Butaleja district that joins the same e-learning classes as a Kampala school, with a tower and solar power also supplying 25 households. Roll-out to other unserved areas waits on a presidential launch.

Digital divides

In the north, a community broadband network built by a women's ICT organisation is in technical testing across 12 sites in Oyam district, with market traders already using it. No user count or model for sustaining it is stated.

Data

National statistics

The bureau went to cultural institutions for the administrative records the civil register does not capture, signing memoranda with the Samia Bugwe and Tieng Adhola institutions on collecting, managing and sharing community-generated information, births and deaths particularly, with the bureau providing technical support and training. Its own argument for it is the interesting part: better administrative records would strengthen the population register and reduce what a national census costs. Neither text is held and no coverage or start date is published.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/UGA/UGA-monthly-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0